

COAI, ETSI team up for telecom standardisation

Industry body Cellular Operators Association of India (COAI) and European Telecommunications Standards Institute (ETSI) have signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) to foster closer co-operation on telecom standardisation. ETSI is a not-for-profit body with over 850 member entities globally, and offers an open and inclusive environment to support development, ratification and testing of globally-applicable standards for information and communications technology (ICT) systems and services across various sectors.

MNRE to lend a hand to green energy developers

Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) has held discussions with state governments to find out how much land they are willing to set aside for renewable energy parks, according to senior officials aware of the development. This follows a recent announcement by the ministry that it will ensure that land and transmission facilities are in place for developers who win wind and solar projects in auctions conducted by Solar Energy Corporation of India (SECI), its nodal agency.

Terra Drone India establishes drone laboratory at Vignan University

Terra Drone India, an associate company of Japan-based Terra Drone Corp., in collaboration with Vignan's Foundation for Science, Technology & Research (deemed-to-be University), has set up a drone laboratory at the latter's campus to foster innovation in unmanned aerial platforms and geographical information systems (GIS) in India. The innovation hub is

being made available to both students as well as industry professionals.

Samsung India witnesses revenue growth

Fighting Chinese competitors with lower-priced phones saw Samsung India's net profit fall by as much as eleven per cent, but revenues grew by ten per cent to cross the milestone of ₹ 600 billion in FY18. While the South Korean giant did not attribute any reason behind the performance in its regulatory filings to Registrar of Companies, two senior industry executives said that the fall in profitability was due to Samsung India's focus on launching price-aggressive smartphones at a relatively lower margin to combat Xiaomi, Oppo, Vivo and OnePlus.

Flipkart forays into manufacturing of electronic appliances for Indian market

India's largest e-tailer Flipkart is reportedly in talks with international original equipment manufacturers (OEMs) to collaborate on manufacturing electronic appliances and products for the Indian market. While Amazon runs a private label called Amazon Basics to offer electronic products to Indian consumers, Flipkart has launched TVs, washing machines and audio accessories under its MarQ brand.

Power ministry to launch mobile app for EV charging slots

Electric vehicle (EV) owners will soon be able to book time-slots at charging stations through a mobile application that will be launched by the power ministry. Through the app, users will be able to check availability of slots at charging stations in the country and book them online, according to a government official.

Taking NTPC'S total capacity won under tariff-based competitive bidding to 345MW, this 100MW solar project shall be set up by NTPC under EPC mode.

With a vision to provide green power through locally-available resources at affordable price, promoting clean energy, NTPC aims to become the country's largest green power producer in the coming years, supplementing the conventional energy sources to ensure competitiveness and mitigate fuel risks. NTPC currently has 11 solar energy-based projects across the country.

Panasonic partners with Tesla to install 100,000 EV charging stations by 2024

In a big move towards tackling vehicular pollution, Japanese electronics giant Panasonic is planning to install over 100,000 charging stations across 25 cities in India. The charging stations will be set up by 2024 to power over one million vehicles.

According to a report in *The Times of India*, the charging stations will be installed at places like malls, parking areas, petrol pumps and other specially-developed zones. Panasonic has partnered with American electric vehicle (EV) maker Tesla for the project.

Some of the cities where the charging stations will be built include Hyderabad, Gurgaon, Noida, Ghaziabad, Delhi, Pune, Bangalore, Chennai and Amravati.

The company maintains that it wants to connect with individual EV owners, logistics companies and fleet owners to function in a green way. The move is expected to cut vehicular pollution in a drastic way.

While Panasonic will control the core network and technologies, the expansion will be made operational through the franchise model.

The company also said that it will pitch telematics solution to utility providers as well as manufacturers of vehicles and equipment to better understand user pattern. It will also help them calibrate products and services accordingly.

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Name, Date and Venue	Topics	Contact address for details
Smart Energy Summit February 17-19, 2020 Austin, USA	Focuses on such topics as smart home and energy efficiency, adoption and innovative business models, smart home and demand response, and much more	Parks Associates Website: www.parksassociates.com
Convergence India 2020 February 19-21, 2020 Pragati Maidan, New Delhi	Communications, broadcast, IT and technology show	Convergence India 2020 Website: www.convergenceindia.org

Since this information is subject to change, all those interested are advised to ascertain the details from the organisers before making any commitment.

participated in the tender floated by Solar Energy Corp. of India (SECI) for 250MW grid-connected solar projects at Dondaicha Solar Park, District,

Dhule, Maharashtra. The Maharatna PSU won 100MW of solar capacities at a tariff of ₹ 2.91 per unit as a part of the reverse auction.